THE SWORN BACHELORS · PART THREE · THE FINALE

The Secret of Durose

Geoffrey × Olivia

His father told him he built it all alone. Then a beautiful stranger in a white suit looked him in the eye and said: "Your father is a thief." Enemies first. The truth second. Love last.

GEOFFREY
The last brother still sworn

OLIVIA
Came to take back everything

JACOB DUROSE
Left a tape for his son

38	~30	9	FINALE
SCENES	MINUTES	TWISTS TO GUESS	OF THE TRILOGY

The cast

GEOFFREY DUROSE
(37). Heir of Durose Holdings. Quiet, gentle and loyal, the "soft heart" of the three brothers, and the last one still sworn.

DONALD IRWIN
(37). Geoffrey's brother. Engaged to Emma, controlling, and terrified of losing the business.

MRS. ADUNNI DUROSE
(62). Geoffrey's mother.

BARRISTER CHIOMA OKONKWO
Lawyer for the Hart estate.

MR. AYO LAWAL
(60s). Elias Hart's personal assistant, in prison for twenty-two years.

UNCLE ROTIMI
Olivia's uncle, who knows the right people.

EMMA
and SOPHIA. Donald's and Michael's women.

OLIVIA HART
(31). CEO of Hartwell Group. Beautiful, sharp and proud. She arrives as his enemy, and she grew up in a house full of lies.

MICHAEL McCLAREN
(37). Geoffrey's brother. With Sophia now, and softer than he used to be.

MAMA GRACE
(58). The woman who raised Olivia.

BABA SULE
(70s). Cleaned Elias Hart's office twenty-two years ago.

CORPORAL IRO
A prison officer.

NURSE
, KEMI (Olivia's best friend), AMAKA (Olivia's PA), BODYGUARD.

NARRATOR
Used only for the opening teaser and two hooks.

Previously...

One week after Part Two. Donald is engaged to Emma. Michael has just confessed his love for Sophia at the premiere. Both have broken the vow, and both know it. On the rooftop, only Geoffrey still says "Still sworn." Then a woman called him and said: "My father died helping build the fortune you inherited. And I think your father killed him."

Geoffrey has always been the rich one. When his father, Jacob Durose, suddenly became wealthy, he told Geoffrey: "Durose Holdings is ours. I built it with my own hands." Geoffrey believed him for twenty-two years.

How to enjoy this PDF

- Tap any scene in the contents to jump straight to it. Your PDF app's bookmarks list every scene too.
- At 9 cliffhangers there is a **Guess the twist** box. Tick your answer (real checkboxes in most PDF apps), then keep reading.
- When a twist is revealed, a green box links back to your guess. All answers are on the last page.
- `VOW TESTED` marks scenes where the brothers fight over the vow. `TRUTH` marks scenes where a piece of the secret comes out.

Scenes

01	What's Coming		0:00
02	The Call		0:34
03	The Woman in White		1:04
04	"Your Father Is a Thief" TRUTH	GUESS ★	1:19
05	"What Are You Hiding, Mama?"	GUESS ★	2:29
06	The Documents		3:19
07	Forged TRUTH		3:30
08	Lockdown		3:57
09	"Who Wants to Fall in Love?" VOW TESTED	GUESS ★	4:33
10	The Woman who Raised Her		5:18
11	The Slap		5:58
12	"Brother, You Made a Vow" VOW TESTED		7:45
13	Baba Sule TRUTH		9:17
14	A Home of Lies		10:17
15	The Shoes		11:31
16	"I Think I'm Falling"		11:52
17	The Prison Gate VOW TESTED		12:34
18	Corporal Iro		13:22
19	Three Days	GUESS ★	14:04
20	Brothers at War VOW TESTED		14:32
21	Released		15:58
22	"She's Not My Woman"		16:24
23	The Escape From the Hospital	GUESS ★	17:26
24	Mr. Lawal TRUTH	GUESS ★	17:57
25	A Kiss on the Cheek		19:16
26	"The Way You Look at Him"		19:55
27	The Intruders VOW TESTED		20:36
28	"What Vow?" VOW TESTED	GUESS ★	21:56
29	Michael Comes VOW TESTED		22:53
30	The Lodge		23:57
31	After the Gunshot		24:07

32	The Truth TRUTH		24:53
33	"I Only Want You"	GUESS ★	26:20
34	The Resignation VOW TESTED		27:08
35	A New Kind of Rich		28:23
36	The Knock	GUESS ★	28:52
37	Cheers to a New Chapter VOW TESTED		29:15
38	The New Vow VOW TESTED		30:35
★	Answer key and your detective score		

SCENE 1 OF 38 · 0:00–0:34

What's Coming

MONTAGE — FLASHES FROM LATER IN THE STORY — NIGHT

> *Quick flashes: a courtroom door slamming, a slap echoing in an old office, a prison cell door clanging shut, a wild dog snarling in the dark, a man walking barefoot on a road at night, two men shouting in a boardroom and a hospital drip being torn out.*

NARRATOR **Geoffrey Durose was the quiet one. The rich one. Before this story ends, he'll lose his company, go to prison, fight his own brothers, and walk barefoot for the woman who came to destroy him.**

> *Flash: OLIVIA HART in a white suit, staring at the camera.*

OLIVIA Your father is a thief.

NARRATOR **This is the last sworn bachelor. *(beat)* And the oldest secret of all.**

↑ All scenes

SCENE 2 OF 38 · 0:34–1:04

The Call

INT. DUROSE HOLDINGS — BOARDROOM, IKOYI — DAY

> *GEOFFREY DUROSE (37) closes a deal with three investors. Handshakes all round. The investors leave. His phone rings.*

GEOFFREY Geoffrey Durose.

BARRISTER OKONKWO (ON PHONE) Mr. Durose, this is Barrister Chioma Okonkwo, counsel to the estate of the late Elias Hart. I need you at my chambers by the High Court, Lagos Island, tomorrow at ten.

GEOFFREY *(frowning)* Elias Hart. What's the issue, Barrister?

BARRISTER OKONKWO (ON PHONE) It's better discussed in person, sir. Tomorrow. Ten o'clock.

> *Click. Geoffrey slowly puts the phone down. He takes the old photograph out of his jacket pocket: "Jacob & Elias. Partners forever. 1998."*

GEOFFREY *(quietly)* Papa. What did you do?

↑ All scenes

SCENE 3 OF 38 · 1:04–1:19

The Woman in White

INT. BARRISTER OKONKWO'S CHAMBERS — WAITING ROOM — 9:55 AM

> *Old law books and a ceiling fan. Geoffrey walks in. One woman sits alone: OLIVIA HART (31), in a perfect white suit and sunglasses, completely still. He gives her a polite nod.*

GEOFFREY Good morning. I guess you're waiting for the barrister too?

> *She lowers her sunglasses slowly, looks him up and down, then puts them back on and turns her face away without a word.*

GEOFFREY *(to himself, sitting)* …Good morning to you too.

> *He sits as far from her as possible. Silence. The fan ticks.*

↑ All scenes

SCENE 4 OF 38 · 1:19–2:29 TRUTH

"Your Father Is a Thief"

INT. BARRISTER OKONKWO'S OFFICE — CONTINUOUS

BARRISTER CHIOMA OKONKWO sits behind a desk piled with files. Geoffrey and Olivia sit facing her, three chairs apart.

BARRISTER OKONKWO Mr. Durose, I'll be direct. Durose Holdings never belonged to your father. It belonged to my client's father, Elias Hart. *(She gestures to Olivia.)* Ms. Olivia Hart.

GEOFFREY *(laughing in disbelief)* No. No, that's not correct. My father founded Durose Holdings. I've seen the documents my whole life.

BARRISTER OKONKWO We have records showing Elias Hart registered the company in 1996. Your father was an employee. Three days after Mr. Hart died, ownership was transferred entirely to Jacob Durose.

GEOFFREY *(standing, voice rising)* That's a lie! My father built that company with his hands! I have the documents!

OLIVIA *(standing too, removing her sunglasses)* Why are you shouting? *(cold)* It's MY father's company. Your father is a thief. He took everything my father built.

Geoffrey freezes. He knows that voice.

GEOFFREY *(slowly)* You're the woman who called me. *(stepping toward her, shaking)* Don't you ever say that about my father again.

OLIVIA *(not moving an inch)* What will you do? Slap me? *(beat)* Like your father slapped me when I was nine years old?

Silence. Geoffrey's face goes blank.

GEOFFREY *(barely audible)* What?

OLIVIA You heard me, Mr. Durose.

Geoffrey looks from Olivia to the barrister, completely lost. He picks up his jacket.

GEOFFREY *(to the barrister)* I'll get back to you.

He walks out. Olivia watches him go, and for a split second her hard face cracks.

GUESS THE TWIST · TICK ONE

Olivia believes Jacob Durose killed her father. Did he?

- ☐ Yes, he murdered Elias
- ☐ No, but he stole the company
- ☐ A third man did it

Revealed in **Scene 32 →**

↑ All scenes

SCENE 5 OF 38 · 2:29–3:19

"What Are You Hiding, Mama?"

INT. DUROSE MANSION, IKOYI — SITTING ROOM — EVENING

A huge, silent house with a large oil portrait of JACOB DUROSE on the wall. MRS. ADUNNI DUROSE (62), elegant, reads her Bible. Geoffrey storms in.

GEOFFREY Mama. A woman came to a lawyer's office today and told me Papa is not the owner of Durose Holdings. That Papa stole it from a man called Elias Hart. *(beat)* Is there anything you're hiding from me?

MRS. DUROSE *(closing the Bible slowly)* Since the day I married your father, he owned that building. He and Elias Hart worked together before. But the company was his.

GEOFFREY She says Papa slapped her. When she was nine.

Mrs. Durose's hand tightens on the Bible. A tiny pause.

MRS. DUROSE Your father had a temper. You know that. *(She looks away.)* But he was not a thief.

GEOFFREY *(staring at the portrait)* Then why do I feel like everybody in this house is lying to me?

He walks out. His mother looks up at the portrait of her husband, and she looks afraid.

GUESS THE TWIST · TICK ONE

"Jacob & Elias. Partners forever." Were they really partners?

- ☐ Yes, equal partners
- ☐ No, Jacob was Elias's employee
- ☐ No, Elias worked for Jacob

Revealed in Scene 13 →

↑ All scenes

SCENE 6 OF 38 · 3:19–3:30

The Documents

INT. JACOB DUROSE'S OLD OFFICE — NIGHT

> *The dusty office from Part One. Geoffrey pulls files from a steel cabinet and finds a leather folder marked "CERTIFICATE OF INCORPORATION — DUROSE HOLDINGS — 1996 — FOUNDER: JACOB DUROSE."*

GEOFFREY *(relieved, almost laughing)* There. There it is. Papa, I knew it.

> *He holds it up to the lamp. His father's signature. A government seal. He doesn't see the tiny smudge under the founder's name.*

↑ All scenes

SCENE 7 OF 38 · 3:30–3:57 TRUTH

Forged

INT. BARRISTER OKONKWO'S OFFICE — NEXT DAY

Geoffrey and his lawyer, MR. BANJO, sit across from Olivia and Barrister Okonkwo. Geoffrey slides the leather folder across the table.

GEOFFREY My father's certificate. 1996. Founder: Jacob Durose. Read it.

Olivia barely glances at it.

OLIVIA It's fake.

GEOFFREY It has a government seal!

OLIVIA So does every fake in Lagos. *(She slides it to Barrister Okonkwo.)* Check it.

The barrister holds the paper under a small UV lamp. Under the purple light, a second name glows faintly beneath "JACOB DUROSE," scraped away and typed over: "ELIAS HART."

BARRISTER OKONKWO *(quietly)* The original name was removed and typed over, Mr. Durose. This document is forged.

Geoffrey stares at the glowing letters. He can't speak.

MR. BANJO *(whispering)* Sir… I think we should go.

Geoffrey stands slowly, as if he's aged ten years, and walks out. Olivia watches him and doesn't look like she's won anything.

↑ All scenes

SCENE 8 OF 38 · 3:57–4:33

Lockdown

EXT. DUROSE HOLDINGS HEADQUARTERS, IKOYI — MORNING

Court officials and police tape seal the glass doors. A notice is pasted on them: "SEALED BY ORDER OF THE HIGH COURT OF LAGOS STATE." Staff stand outside, confused. Geoffrey's car pulls up, and right behind it, Donald's Range Rover and Michael's G-Wagon.

DONALD *(jumping out)* Geoffrey! What is this? The banks just froze Three Boys Ventures! Durose Holdings carries a third of everything we own together!

MICHAEL My studio's account is frozen too! I have a crew of two hundred waiting to be paid!

COURT OFFICIAL Sirs, the court has sealed this company pending a claim of ownership. The claimant says Jacob Durose was never the owner.

DONALD *(turning slowly to Geoffrey)* Never the owner?

Geoffrey looks at the sealed doors, at his father's name on the gate and at his brothers. He doesn't say a word. He gets back into his car and drives away.

MICHAEL Geoffrey! GEOFFREY!

↑ All scenes

SCENE 9 OF 38 · 4:33–5:18 VOW TESTED

"Who Wants to Fall in Love?"

INT. GEOFFREY'S HOUSE, BANANA ISLAND — NIGHT

> *Geoffrey sits in the dark with a drink. Donald and Michael let themselves in. Geoffrey tells them everything.*

GEOFFREY A forged certificate. My father's handwriting, over another man's name. Twenty-two years, and I've been sitting in a stolen chair.

MICHAEL *(gently)* You didn't know.

DONALD *(pacing)* Knowing doesn't matter to the banks, Michael. We have billions tied to that company.

GEOFFREY *(laughing bitterly)* And her. Olivia Hart. She called my father a thief to my face. *(He raises his glass.)* This is why I'm grateful for that vow. Who on God's earth wants to fall in love? With a woman like that? Rude. Proud. Cruel. *(beat)* Thank God for rule four.

> *Behind him, Donald and Michael slowly look at each other. Donald is engaged. Michael has just confessed in front of a thousand people. Neither says a word.*

MICHAEL *(clearing his throat)* ...Yes. Rule four. Very... important rule.

DONALD *(sipping his drink)* Very.

GUESS THE TWIST · TICK ONE

“Who wants to fall in love with a woman like that?” Will Geoffrey break the vow?

- ☐ Never, he's the last one sworn
- ☐ Yes, for Olivia

Revealed in Scene 34 →

↑ All scenes

SCENE 10 OF 38 · 5:18–5:58

The Woman who Raised Her

INT. OLIVIA'S PENTHOUSE, IKOYI — NIGHT

> *Olivia sits on the balcony, her heels kicked off. MAMA GRACE (58), gentle, brings her tea.*

MAMA GRACE You won today. Why do you look like you lost?

OLIVIA *(staring at the city)* Because of his face, Mama, when the lawyer showed him the forgery. He really didn't know. *(beat)* I watched something die in his eyes.

MAMA GRACE You've waited twenty-two years for the truth, my daughter.

OLIVIA I wanted the truth. I didn't want to break a man who was lied to the same way I was. *(She sets down the tea.)* I'm going to see him.

MAMA GRACE At this hour?

OLIVIA Tomorrow. *(beat)* Before I lose my courage.

↑ All scenes

SCENE 11 OF 38 · 5:58–7:45

The Slap

INT. GEOFFREY'S HOUSE — FRONT DOOR / SITTING ROOM — NEXT DAY

A knock. Geoffrey opens the door, unshaven and in a T-shirt. Olivia stands there without the sunglasses or the white suit, just a simple dress.

GEOFFREY *(stunned)* How do you know where I live?

OLIVIA I asked a friend who knows a friend. This is Lagos. *(beat)* May I come in?

Inside, they sit at opposite ends of the sofa.

OLIVIA I came to say I'm sorry. For "thief." I was angry for twenty-two years and I threw all of it at you.

GEOFFREY *(quietly)* It's alright. *(beat)* But I need to ask you something. You said my father slapped you. When?

She looks at her hands for a long moment.

OLIVIA I was nine. I found your father alone in Papa's office, going through Papa's papers. I said, "Uncle Jacob, why are you touching Papa's things?" *(beat)* He slapped me so hard I fell. Then he whispered, "If you ever tell your father, you'll regret the day you were born." *(beat)* Papa died three weeks later. I never told anyone.

Geoffrey closes his eyes. His jaw shakes.

GEOFFREY I'm sorry. *(His voice breaks.)* I'm so sorry my father did that to you. I didn't know. I swear to God, I didn't know.

OLIVIA I know. *(beat)* My father lied to me too, Geoffrey. He beat the woman who raised me. He hid things from me my whole childhood. *(She smiles sadly.)* I forgot you might be going through the same thing. I'm sorry for that too.

A long silence. Two children of liars, sitting on one sofa.

GEOFFREY Then let's stop guessing. Let's go to the bottom of this. Both of us. Whatever the truth is, even if it's ugly.

OLIVIA *(after a beat)* I know where to start. There's an old man, Baba Sule. He cleaned my father's office when Papa was alive. He saw everything.

GEOFFREY Then we'll go and see Baba Sule.

↑ All scenes

SCENE 12 OF 38 · 7:45–9:17 VOW TESTED

"Brother, You Made a Vow"

EXT. THREE BOYS VENTURES — CAR PARK, IKOYI — MORNING

Donald and Michael stand by their cars. Geoffrey arrives with a travel bag.

GEOFFREY I'm going on a trip. A few days. I need to clear my head.

DONALD *(exploding)* A TRIP? The banks have frozen us and you're going on a TRIP? Do you know how much WE put into that company?

MICHAEL Donald, calm down. Calm down. *(to Geoffrey)* What kind of trip? Vacation?

GEOFFREY I'm going to prove the company belongs to my father. That's all. I'm going to get it back for all of us.

MICHAEL *(relaxing)* Okay. Okay, that's good. Is that all?

GEOFFREY That's all.

A huge black SUV glides into the car park. The rear window slides down. Olivia leans out, smiling.

OLIVIA Geoffrey! I'm here. Are you ready?

Donald and Michael turn very, very slowly to look at Geoffrey.

DONALD *(dangerously quiet)* Brother. You made a vow.

GEOFFREY Calm down. Calm down! I'm not doing anything with her. We're going to find the truth, that's all.

MICHAEL "We"? You and the woman who froze our accounts?

DONALD Are you about to sell the company to her? Is that it?

GEOFFREY I'm not selling anything! I'm still in the vow. No woman can shake me. *(firm)* I'm proving this business belongs to my father. Nothing more. I know my father. I believe him.

A long, tense beat.

MICHAEL Fine. Just stay in touch with us.

Donald gets into his car and slams the door without another word. Michael follows. Geoffrey walks to the SUV and gets in beside Olivia.

OLIVIA *(watching the cars leave)* Wow. Is that how your friends talk to you? *(beat)* That's toxic, Geoffrey. Nobody should talk to you like that.

GEOFFREY *(quietly)* They're my brothers. That's just how they talk.

OLIVIA *(looking at him)* That's not an answer.

↑ All scenes

SCENE 13 OF 38 · 9:17–10:17 TRUTH

Baba Sule

EXT. BABA SULE'S COMPOUND, ABEOKUTA — DAY

A small, neat compound under a mango tree. BABA SULE (70s) sits on a bench with a walking stick. Olivia kneels to greet him in the traditional way. Geoffrey bows.

BABA SULE *(squinting)* Olivia? Little Olivia Hart? *(He laughs and takes her face in his hands.)* You used to steal sugar from the office tea tray!

OLIVIA *(laughing)* Baba, you never reported me.

BABA SULE *(turning to Geoffrey and going cold)* And this one has his father's face. *(beat)* Jacob's son.

GEOFFREY Yes, Baba. I've come for the truth. Even if it's about my father.

BABA SULE *(after a long pause)* I left that office because Jacob Durose fired me. Two weeks after Elias died. He said I was "too old to clean." *(He taps his stick.)* I was forty-eight.

GEOFFREY Were they partners, Baba? My father and Mr. Hart?

BABA SULE Partners? *(He laughs sadly.)* My son, Elias Hart owned that company. Your father was his clerk. He worked like a donkey for fifteen years, and every year Elias promised him shares. "Next year, Jacob." *(beat)* He never gave him one.

Geoffrey sits down slowly on the bench. He takes out the photograph: "Jacob & Elias. Partners forever. 1998."

GEOFFREY *(whispering)* He wrote "partners" on a photograph. And never on a contract.

TWIST REVEALED · "Jacob & Elias. Partners forever." Were they really partners? The answer: **No, Jacob was Elias's employee**. See what you guessed in Scene 5 →

↑ All scenes

SCENE 14 OF 38 · 10:17–11:31

A Home of Lies

INT. SMALL RESTAURANT, ABEOKUTA — EVENING

> *A quiet local restaurant with plates of amala and ewedu and a ceiling fan. Geoffrey and Olivia eat, and for the first time they're relaxed.*

OLIVIA You eat amala like a man who's never seen food.

GEOFFREY I grew up in Ajegunle before my father got rich. Amala was a Sunday luxury.

OLIVIA *(surprised)* You? Ajegunle? I thought you were born with a silver spoon.

GEOFFREY Plastic spoon. The silver one arrived when I was fifteen, the week my father said "something happened." *(beat)* Now I know what happened. Your father died.

> *Olivia puts down her spoon.*

OLIVIA Want to know the biggest lie of my life? The woman who raised me isn't my mother. At fifteen, I found a lawyer's letter in Papa's drawer. My real mother died giving birth to me. And my grandfather had left me an island in the Lekki lagoon. Papa hid both from me.

GEOFFREY *(softly)* Fifteen. That's when my father's lies began, and yours ended.

OLIVIA We grew up in two houses full of lies, Geoffrey. Different houses. Same lies.

> *They look at each other for a long moment, a little too long.*

GEOFFREY *(clearing his throat)* Would you… like to hang out some more? After this?

OLIVIA *(raising an eyebrow, smiling)* Are we not hanging out right now?

↑ All scenes

SCENE 15 OF 38 · 11:31–11:52

The Shoes

EXT. ABEOKUTA STREET — NIGHT

> *A long road under streetlights. They walk slowly back to the hotel, talking and laughing. Olivia winces with every step. Her very high heels are killing her.*

GEOFFREY You're limping.

OLIVIA I'm fine. CEOs don't limp.

GEOFFREY *(stopping)* Sit.

> *He sits her down on a low wall, kneels and takes off his own shoes and socks.*

OLIVIA Geoffrey, what are you doing?

GEOFFREY *(gently removing her heels and slipping his shoes onto her feet)* They're too big. But they're flat.

OLIVIA And you?

GEOFFREY *(standing barefoot on the road, holding her heels)* I grew up in Ajegunle. My feet remember.

> *They walk on. She shuffles in his giant shoes, laughing. He walks barefoot beside her, carrying her heels. Every few steps, she looks at him.*

↑ All scenes

SCENE 16 OF 38 · 11:52–12:34

"I Think I'm Falling"

INT. HOTEL — OLIVIA'S ROOM / GEOFFREY'S ROOM — NIGHT — SPLIT SCREEN

LEFT: Olivia lies on the bed, still wearing his shoes, on the phone with her best friend KEMI.

OLIVIA Kemi. He gave me his shoes. He walked home barefoot. A billionaire, barefoot on the road in Abeokuta.

KEMI
ON PHONE
Olivia Hart. Are you smiling? I can HEAR you smiling!

OLIVIA *(covering her face)* I think… I think I'm falling in love with him, Kemi. The son of the man who slapped me. What is wrong with me?

RIGHT: Geoffrey stands at the bathroom mirror, staring at himself.

GEOFFREY *(to his reflection)* You are NOT falling for this girl. *(beat)* She's beautiful. She's brilliant. She understands you without a word. *(He grips the sink.)* And you made a vow. With your brothers.

He looks down at his dusty bare feet and smiles anyway.

GEOFFREY …Oh, God.

↑ All scenes

SCENE 17 OF 38 · 12:34–13:22 VOW TESTED

The Prison Gate

EXT. AGODI CORRECTIONAL CENTRE, IBADAN — WAITING AREA — DAY

> *A dusty waiting area with long benches. Baba Sule told them that Elias Hart's personal assistant, Mr. Ayo Lawal, has been in this prison for twenty-two years. Olivia and Geoffrey sit and wait. Geoffrey's phone rings: DONALD.*

GEOFFREY *(standing)* Excuse me. I have to take this.

> *He walks to the far end of the yard.*

GEOFFREY Donald.

DONALD ON PHONE Where are you? Have you proved it yet? Have you shown that girl the company is your father's?

GEOFFREY I'm working on it. Calm down.

DONALD ON PHONE I'm serious, Geoffrey. She picked you up in her car. Same hotel. Are you dating her?

GEOFFREY I am NOT dating her! I'm still in the vow! *(beat)* And Donald? I hate the way you talk to me. You don't know how to talk to me.

DONALD ON PHONE *(scoffing)* Oh. Oh, now she's told you that too? "Toxic"? I can hear her words in your mouth, Geoffrey—

> *Geoffrey hangs up and switches the phone off.*

↑ All scenes

SCENE 18 OF 38 · 13:22–14:04

Corporal Iro

EXT. PRISON WAITING AREA — CONTINUOUS

A prison officer, CORPORAL IRO, sits down far too close to Olivia.

CORPORAL IRO Fine girl. You're too beautiful for this kind of place. Give me your number. I'll make sure you see your person quickly.

OLIVIA *(moving away)* No, thank you.

CORPORAL IRO *(grabbing her wrist)* Ah-ah! Why are you forming? Just your number—

OLIVIA Leave me alone! Get your hands off me!

Across the yard, Geoffrey turns at her scream. He runs, grabs the officer by the collar, pulls him off Olivia and shoves him hard to the ground.

GEOFFREY Don't you EVER touch her!

Whistles blow. Four officers rush in and tackle Geoffrey to the ground, beating him with batons.

OLIVIA Stop! STOP! He was protecting me! Let him go!

CORPORAL IRO *(dusting himself off, sneering)* He assaulted an officer of the state. He'll sleep inside today. And tomorrow. And the day after.

They drag Geoffrey away. He looks back at Olivia, bleeding from his lip.

GEOFFREY *(calling out)* Are you hurt? Olivia! Are you hurt?

The steel gate clangs shut.

↑ All scenes

SCENE 19 OF 38 · 14:04–14:32

Three Days

INT. PRISON CELL — NIGHT / INT. OLIVIA'S SUV — NIGHT — INTERCUT

> *A crowded, dark cell. Geoffrey sits against the wall with bruises on his face, still barefoot because they took his shoes at the gate.*

> *In her SUV, Olivia is on the phone, crying and furious, while her BODYGUARD drives.*

OLIVIA Uncle Rotimi, please. They've had him for a day. They're beating him. I don't care who you call. Call the Controller-General. Call the governor. Call God!

UNCLE ROTIMI *ON PHONE* Calm down, my daughter. I know the Controller. I'll make the call tonight. But who is this man to you?

> *Olivia doesn't answer.*

GUESS THE TWIST · TICK ONE

Geoffrey is locked in a cell. Who gets him out?

- ☐ Donald and Michael
- ☐ Olivia's Uncle Rotimi
- ☐ He breaks out himself

Revealed in **Scene 21 →**

↑ All scenes

SCENE 20 OF 38 · 14:32–15:58 VOW TESTED

Brothers at War

INT. THREE BOYS VENTURES — BOARDROOM — DAY — DAY THREE

Donald paces with his phone to his ear while Michael sits.

DONALD Third day. Not one call. *(He throws the phone down.)* I KNEW it. He's fallen for her.

MICHAEL Calm down, Donald. Geoffrey won't do that. Not with the business on the line.

DONALD Geoffrey has the softest heart of the three of us! You know it! A woman like that eats a soft heart for breakfast!

MICHAEL *(standing)* And so what if he did? You're engaged! I declared my love in front of a thousand people! We're the last people on earth who can shout "vow" at him!

DONALD That's different. Emma never froze our bank accounts.

MICHAEL No. Emma just got you to give away Everys for one naira. Remember?

DONALD *(pointing at him)* Don't.

MICHAEL You know why you're unbearable? Geoffrey and I put more money into Durose than you did, and for once you're not in control of it!

DONALD *(roaring)* I'm trying to SAVE all of us!

MICHAEL By chasing away the only brother who never once asked you for anything?

Silence. Donald grabs his keys.

DONALD This is nonsense.

He storms out.

INT. DONALD'S CAR — MOMENTS LATER. Donald grips the wheel. He calls Emma.

EMMA (ON PHONE) Hi, you.

DONALD *(quietly)* Emma. Am I becoming the man who stops his brother from being happy?

EMMA (ON PHONE) *(gently)* You're becoming the man who's scared of losing his brother. *(beat)* But Donald, those look exactly the same from the outside.

Donald closes his eyes.

↑ All scenes

SCENE 21 OF 38 · 15:58–16:24

Released

EXT. AGODI CORRECTIONAL CENTRE — GATE — NIGHT

> *The gate opens. Geoffrey limps out, bruised and filthy, and still barefoot. Olivia runs to him. Uncle Rotimi stands by the cars.*

OLIVIA *(touching his swollen face)* Look what they did to you. Look what I did to you.

GEOFFREY *(weakly smiling)* You didn't do anything. *(beat)* Did he touch you again? After I was gone?

OLIVIA *(crying)* Three days in a cell, and that's your first question?

GEOFFREY It's the only question.

> *His knees buckle. She catches him.*

OLIVIA *(shouting)* Hospital! NOW!

TWIST REVEALED · Geoffrey is locked in a cell. Who gets him out? The answer: **Olivia's Uncle Rotimi**.
See what you guessed in Scene 19 →

↑ All scenes

SCENE 22 OF 38 · 16:24–17:26

"She's Not My Woman"

INT. PRIVATE HOSPITAL ROOM, IBADAN — DAY

Geoffrey lies in bed with a drip in his arm. Olivia sits beside him, spoon-feeding him pepper soup she cooked herself.

GEOFFREY I can feed myself.

OLIVIA You can't even lift a cup. Open.

He opens his mouth obediently. A NURSE enters and checks his vitals.

NURSE How are you feeling today, sir?

GEOFFREY Better, thank you. Just some painkillers, please.

Olivia steps out to take a call. The nurse lowers her voice and smiles.

NURSE Sir, I've worked here eleven years. I have never seen a woman take care of a man the way your woman takes care of you.

GEOFFREY *(quickly)* Ah, she's not my woman.

NURSE *(hands on hips)* Are you sure? She cooked that soup at five this morning. And she's slept in that chair two nights.

GEOFFREY We're… just friends.

NURSE *(leaving)* Hmm. Okay, sir. "Friends."

Olivia returns and sits. She is quiet for a moment.

OLIVIA I'm sorry. I put you in danger. You went to prison because of me.

GEOFFREY You didn't. *(beat)* My father taught me many wrong things. My mother taught me one right one: a man doesn't stand there while a woman is touched against her will. *(beat)* I'd do it again.

She looks at him, and her eyes fill up.

↑ All scenes

SCENE 23 OF 38 · 17:26–17:57

The Escape From the Hospital

INT. HOSPITAL ROOM — NIGHT

> *Olivia picks up her bag.*

OLIVIA Tomorrow I'm going back to the prison. Alone. I'll see Mr. Lawal myself. You need to rest.

GEOFFREY *(trying to sit up)* No. No, I'm coming with you.

OLIVIA Geoffrey, you can barely sit up!

GEOFFREY I'm not letting you walk back into that place alone.

OLIVIA *(blushing slightly, firm)* You're staying in this bed. That's final. Goodnight.

> *She leaves. Later, the nurse turns off the light.*

NURSE Sleep now, sir. Doctor's orders.

> *The door closes. In the dark, Geoffrey's phone lights up his face. He looks at the drip in his arm, then at the door. He pulls the tape off and slides the drip out, wincing. He pulls on his clothes, limps to the window and slips out.*

GUESS THE TWIST · TICK ONE

Olivia ordered him to stay in his hospital bed. Will he?

- ☐ Yes, he rests
- ☐ No, he pulls out his drip and follows her

Revealed in Scene 24 →

↑ All scenes

SCENE 24 OF 38 · 17:57–19:16 TRUTH

Mr. Lawal

INT. AGODI CORRECTIONAL CENTRE — VISITING ROOM — NEXT MORNING

> *Olivia sits alone at a scratched table. The door opens behind her, and she turns. It's Geoffrey, pale, bruised and leaning on the door frame.*

OLIVIA *(standing, shocked)* What are you doing here?! You're supposed to be in hospital!

GEOFFREY I told you. There's no way I'm letting you walk in here alone.

OLIVIA *(half angry, half melting)* You're impossible.

> *Another door opens. Two guards bring in MR. AYO LAWAL (60s), thin and grey in a faded prison uniform. He sits and squints at Olivia.*

MR. LAWAL Who are you? What do you want from me?

OLIVIA *(softly)* I'm Olivia, sir. Elias Hart's daughter.

> *Mr. Lawal's face crumples. His hands shake.*

MR. LAWAL Olivia? Little Olivia? *(He reaches for her hands.)* You've grown. You've grown so much. *(urgently)* Tell me you took your father's company back from that wicked man. Tell me you did it.

> *Olivia and Geoffrey look at each other.*

OLIVIA Which wicked man, sir?

MR. LAWAL Jacob Durose! *(His voice rises.)* When your father died, I went to tell the lawyers the papers had been changed. Jacob had me arrested first. Forged cheques in my desk. *(He's crying.)* Twenty-two years, my daughter, for a crime I never committed.

> *Silence. Olivia covers her mouth. Geoffrey stands up slowly.*

OLIVIA *(gently)* Mr. Lawal. This is Geoffrey. *(beat)* Jacob's son.

> *Mr. Lawal stares at Geoffrey with fear, then anger. Geoffrey walks around the table, kneels on the prison floor in front of the old man and takes his shaking hands.*

GEOFFREY Sir. I'm so sorry for what my father did to you. *(His voice breaks.)* I can't give you back twenty-two years. But I swear on my life, I'll get you out. Please forgive me.

> *A long, long silence. Then Mr. Lawal places a trembling hand on Geoffrey's head, like a blessing.*

MR. LAWAL *(crying)* You're not your father, my son. *(beat)* Listen. He never destroyed the real documents. Too proud. Look where he kept his guns.

TWIST REVEALED · Olivia ordered him to stay in his hospital bed. Will he? The answer: **No, he pulls out his drip and follows her**. See what you guessed in Scene 23 →

GUESS THE TWIST · TICK ONE

Where are the real company documents?

- ☐ In his mother's house
- ☐ In Jacob's lodge, with the guns
- ☐ In a bank vault abroad

Revealed in Scene 32 →

↑ All scenes

SCENE 25 OF 38 · 19:16–19:55

A Kiss on the Cheek

EXT. PRISON CAR PARK — DAY

> *Olivia helps Geoffrey toward the SUV. She is shaking with emotion.*

OLIVIA We have to get that old man out. Today. He's too old for that place.

GEOFFREY Of course. But first we need the documents, to prove my father forged—

OLIVIA *(stopping him)* No. The documents can wait. A man's life can't. *(beat)* My lawyer will get him out. And you're going back to that hospital. Right now.

GEOFFREY Olivia—

OLIVIA Your company matters, Geoffrey. Your father's name matters. But your life comes first.

> *Then, without warning, she leans up and kisses his cheek, quickly and softly. She gets into the car before he can react.*

> *Geoffrey stands frozen in the car park with his hand on his cheek.*

GEOFFREY *(whispering to himself)* Have I found my lady?

↑ All scenes

SCENE 26 OF 38 · 19:55–20:36

"The Way You Look at Him"

EXT. AGODI CORRECTIONAL CENTRE — GATE — EVENING — TWO DAYS LATER

> *The gate opens. Mr. Lawal walks out in new clothes and blinks at the sky. Olivia and Barrister Okonkwo wait for him. He grabs Olivia's hands.*

MR. LAWAL Free. After twenty-two years. God bless you, my daughter.

OLIVIA Thank Geoffrey. He's paying for your lawyer. And your house. And your pension.

MR. LAWAL *(studying her face, smiling)* Olivia. Are you sure there's nothing between you and that boy?

OLIVIA *(too fast)* What do you mean?

MR. LAWAL I'm an old man. I've been in a cell for twenty-two years. But I'm not blind. *(beat)* The way you two look at each other. That's not business. *(He pats her hand.)* Go to him. Life is too short to stay in prison by choice.

↑ All scenes

SCENE 27 OF 38 · 20:36–21:56 VOW TESTED

The Intruders

INT. GEOFFREY'S HOUSE — DAY — ONE WEEK LATER

> *Geoffrey, discharged and still bruised, unlocks his front door. Olivia is beside him, carrying his bag. She insisted on seeing him home safely. The door swings open. Donald and Michael are sitting in his living room.*

GEOFFREY *(startled)* Jesus! What are you doing in my house? How did you even get my key?

DONALD *(standing)* Is that really the question you should be asking right now? *(beat)* What happened to the business? Did you prove to this girl that it's yours?

GEOFFREY Donald, please. Stop it. Can't you see I'm not well?

DONALD I can see you've been gone two weeks and you've come home with HER.

OLIVIA *(stepping forward)* Is this how you talk to him? He just came out of hospital. He deserves respect. *(beat)* And what business are you talking about? What do you mean "OUR" business?

> *Donald stares at her. Then he laughs coldly.*

DONALD Oh. You didn't tell her? *(to Geoffrey)* You didn't tell her we're partners? I suppose you were busy falling in love.

GEOFFREY *(shaking)* Donald. Get out of my house.

DONALD *(to Olivia)* That company isn't yours yet. And if you think you can use your father's business to get to us through Geoffrey's soft heart, it won't happen.

MICHAEL *(grabbing Donald's arm)* Okay. Okay, Donald, it's enough. Let's go. Let's go NOW.

> *Michael pulls Donald toward the door. Geoffrey catches Michael's sleeve.*

GEOFFREY *(low, hurt)* How did you allow this, Michael?

MICHAEL *(sadly)* Brother, I don't know what's wrong with Donald these days.

> *They leave. The door shuts. Silence.*

↑ All scenes

SCENE 28 OF 38 · 21:56–22:53 VOW TESTED

"What Vow?"

INT. GEOFFREY'S HOUSE — CONTINUOUS

OLIVIA *(quietly)* What vow, Geoffrey? What partnership? *(beat)* Tell me the truth.

GEOFFREY *(sitting heavily)* Donald and Michael own part of Durose through our partnership. The court froze them too. *(beat)* And years ago, the three of us vowed on a rooftop never to fall in love.

> *Olivia goes very still.*

OLIVIA So all this time, when you defended me, gave me your shoes, went to prison for me… you were what? Keeping your vow? Protecting your partners' money?

GEOFFREY No. Olivia, that's not—

OLIVIA *(standing, her voice breaking)* Do you think I WANTED to fall in love with you? With Jacob Durose's son? *(beat)* Is that how you've been looking at me? As a threat to your vow? A woman trying to "get to you"?

GEOFFREY *(standing)* Olivia, please—

> *She walks out. He limps after her to the gate, but her BODYGUARD steps between them.*

BODYGUARD Sir. Madam said no.

> *The SUV drives away. Geoffrey stands at his gate, alone again.*

GUESS THE TWIST · TICK ONE

Olivia walked out over the vow. What brings them back together?

- [ ] A love letter
- [ ] Danger at the lodge
- [ ] Donald apologises

Revealed in Scene 31 →

↑ All scenes

SCENE 29 OF 38 · 22:53–23:57 VOW TESTED

Michael Comes

INT. GEOFFREY'S HOUSE — NIGHT — DAYS LATER

> *Curtains closed, food untouched. Geoffrey hasn't left the house in days. Michael lets himself in and sits beside him.*

MICHAEL I'm sorry, brother. For Donald. For everything he said.

GEOFFREY *(staring at nothing)* It's fine. It's what I signed up for, isn't it? I made a vow. This is what it costs.

MICHAEL No. We made that vow like hungry boys from Ajegunle, afraid of losing anything. We didn't grow up with love. We grew up with hardship.

GEOFFREY *(slowly turning)* What are you trying to say, Michael?

MICHAEL We're getting old. We've worked hard. We need a little love. *(He smiles.)* Sophia completes me. I don't know how she does it. I'd sell my studio tomorrow for her.

GEOFFREY *(quietly)* And Donald?

MICHAEL Donald is scared. That's his wahala, not yours. Don't let his fear make your decisions. *(He stands.)* Where is Olivia right now?

GEOFFREY *(a sudden realisation)* …She said she'd look for the documents. Alone. At my father's lodge. *(He grabs his keys.)* Michael, my father kept his guns at the lodge.

↑ All scenes

SCENE 30 OF 38 · 23:57–24:07

The Lodge

EXT/INT. JACOB DUROSE'S HUNTING LODGE, OGUN FOREST — NIGHT

An old, abandoned lodge deep in the forest. Olivia pushes the creaking door open with a phone torch. Dust, animal heads on the walls and an old gun cabinet. She searches drawers and shelves. A low growl comes from the dark. She freezes. A huge, starving WILD DOG steps out from behind the sofa, teeth bared.

OLIVIA *(backing away, whispering)* No. No, no, no...

The dog lunges. Olivia screams and runs, through the corridor and out the back door into the trees, with the dog snarling right behind her.

Headlights sweep the trees as Geoffrey's car skids to a stop outside. He hears her scream and runs into the lodge, straight to the gun cabinet, and smashes the glass with his elbow.

Olivia trips on a root and falls hard. The dog leaps.

BANG.

The dog drops dead at her feet. Olivia screams again, then stares through the torchlight. Geoffrey stands there, breathing hard, holding his father's old rifle.

↑ All scenes

SCENE 31 OF 38 · 24:07–24:53

After the Gunshot

EXT. LODGE — BACK GARDEN — CONTINUOUS

Geoffrey drops the rifle and runs to her. He pulls her up and checks her arms and face.

GEOFFREY Are you hurt? Did it bite you? Olivia, look at me!

OLIVIA *(shaking)* I'm okay. I'm okay. *(beat)* What are you doing here? *(She stares at the rifle on the grass.)* And since when do you know how to use a gun?

GEOFFREY *(quietly)* My father's toxic habit. Guns everywhere. At ten, he made me learn to shoot. *(beat)* I hated him for it. Tonight, for the first time, I'm glad.

OLIVIA *(crying now)* I'm sorry. For walking out. For what I said.

GEOFFREY I'm sorry I was stupid enough to let you come here alone.

They look at each other in the moonlight. Slowly, they hold each other tight. They don't kiss. He kisses her forehead.

GEOFFREY *(whispering)* I hope you're okay.

OLIVIA *(into his chest)* I am now. *(beat)* Let's find those documents.

TWIST REVEALED · Olivia walked out over the vow. What brings them back together? The answer: **Danger at the lodge**. See what you guessed in Scene 28 →

↑ All scenes

SCENE 32 OF 38 · 24:53–26:20 TRUTH

The Truth

INT. LODGE — STUDY — NIGHT

Behind the smashed gun cabinet, Geoffrey finds a hidden steel box. Inside are the ORIGINAL certificate, "DUROSE HOLDINGS — 1996 — FOUNDER: ELIAS HART", and an old VHS tape labelled in Jacob's handwriting: "FOR GEOFFREY. WHEN I'M GONE."

They play it on an old TV and VCR in the corner. JACOB DUROSE, older and tired, sits in this same room and speaks to the camera.

JACOB DUROSE (ON TAPE) Geoffrey. If you're watching this, you've found the truth. *(beat)* Elias Hart owned this company. I was his clerk for fifteen years. I missed your birthdays for him. Every December he promised me shares, and every December he gave me nothing. He wrote "partners" on a photograph and laughed when I asked for it in writing.

Olivia's hand goes to her mouth.

JACOB DUROSE (ON TAPE) When his heart failed at his desk, I didn't kill him, my son. God is my witness. But that night, I took what he never gave me. I changed the papers. And when his assistant tried to stop me, I sent an innocent man to prison. *(His voice breaks.)* And once I slapped a little girl who saw me. I've never forgiven myself for that.

Geoffrey is crying silently. Olivia takes his hand.

JACOB DUROSE (ON TAPE) I gave you everything, Geoffrey. Except the truth. I'm sorry.

The tape crackles to static. A long silence.

OLIVIA *(very softly)* I knew Papa was hard. I didn't know he was cruel. *(to Geoffrey)* I'm sorry for what my father did to yours.

GEOFFREY And I'm sorry for what mine did to you. *(He looks at the certificate.)* The company is yours. I'll sign it over.

OLIVIA *(shaking her head)* I don't need it, Geoffrey. I have more than I can spend. *(beat)* I only wanted the truth. And now I know.

TWIST REVEALED · Olivia believes Jacob Durose killed her father. Did he? The answer: **No, but he stole the company**. See what you guessed in Scene 4 →

TWIST REVEALED · Where are the real company documents? The answer: **In Jacob's lodge, with the guns**. See what you guessed in Scene 24 →

↑ All scenes

SCENE 33 OF 38 · 26:20–27:08

"I Only Want You"

INT. LODGE — STUDY — CONTINUOUS

GEOFFREY *(standing, facing her)* Then keep it or burn it. I don't want the company either.

OLIVIA What do you want?

GEOFFREY I want you.

> *She stares at him.*

OLIVIA What do you mean by that?

GEOFFREY What do you think I mean? *(beat)* Tell me you don't see what I see. We grew up in the same lies, Olivia. You're the first true thing I've ever found.

OLIVIA *(tears falling)* You don't mean it. You made a vow.

GEOFFREY I don't care about any vow. *(beat)* I'd walk out of the company. I'd walk barefoot from here to Lagos. *(softly)* I mean it with everything I have.

OLIVIA *(whispering)* You mean that?

GEOFFREY Yes.

> *She walks into his arms. They hold each other. Slowly, their faces come closer and closer. The old TV's static glow flickers and fades to black.*

GUESS THE TWIST · TICK ONE

Geoffrey chose Olivia. What happens to the brothers' empire?

- ☐ Olivia takes it
- ☐ They sell everything
- ☐ Geoffrey and Michael walk away and leave it all to Donald

Revealed in Scene 34 →

↑ All scenes

SCENE 34 OF 38 · 27:08–28:23 VOW TESTED

The Resignation

INT. THREE BOYS VENTURES — BOARDROOM — DAY

Donald sits at the head of the table and Michael on the side. Geoffrey walks in, calm, with a leather folder. Donald stands.

DONALD I hope you've come with good news.

GEOFFREY I have. *(He sits.)* I couldn't prove the company was my father's, because it wasn't. Elias Hart founded it. My father forged the papers and jailed an innocent man. *(beat)* Olivia doesn't want the company. So it will carry its true founder's name, and every naira I made from it goes to the Elias Hart Foundation and to Mr. Lawal.

DONALD *(stunned)* That's your entire fortune.

GEOFFREY It was never my fortune. *(beat)* And I broke the vow. I'm in love with Olivia Hart. *(He slides a signed document across.)* My resignation from the partnership. My shares are yours, Donald. *(He stands.)* Thank you, brothers. *(beat)* Michael, I think you know what you need to do too.

He walks out. Donald stares at the paper.

DONALD What… what just happened?

Michael quietly takes an envelope from his jacket and puts it on the table.

MICHAEL I'm sorry, Donald. I've chased deals my whole life. Sophia makes me feel like more than my next deal. *(beat)* I'm stepping out too. I want to make films and come home on time.

He walks out. Donald sits alone at the long table with two resignation letters and the whole empire.

DONALD *(to the empty room)* …Do you think I wanted to own all of this alone?

TWIST REVEALED · "Who wants to fall in love with a woman like that?" Will Geoffrey break the vow? The answer: **Yes, for Olivia**. See what you guessed in Scene 9 →

TWIST REVEALED · Geoffrey chose Olivia. What happens to the brothers' empire? The answer: **Geoffrey and Michael walk away and leave it all to Donald**. See what you guessed in Scene 33 →

↑ All scenes

SCENE 35 OF 38 · 28:23–28:52

A New Kind of Rich

MONTAGE — LAGOS — WEEKS LATER

> *Michael and Sophia on the beach at Badagry, laughing as she reads him a new script and he actually listens.*

> *Hartwell Group offices. Geoffrey, with no company and no fortune, works at a desk across from Olivia's glass office. He opens doors for her, carries her files and brings her amala on Fridays. Colleagues whisper and smile.*

AMAKA *(Olivia's PA, leaning on her desk)* Madam, I see the way you look at him. Like he hung the moon.

OLIVIA *(not looking up, smiling)* You know I do, Amaka.

> *EXT. LAGOON — SUNSET. A small boat, an island and a table for two. Geoffrey kneels on the sand with a simple ring.*

GEOFFREY I have no company. No fortune. Only my word, which I promise will never be a lie. *(beat)* Olivia Hart, will you marry me?

OLIVIA *(laughing and crying)* On my own island? Yes. Yes!

↑ All scenes

SCENE 36 OF 38 · 28:52–29:15

The Knock

INT. GEOFFREY'S SMALL NEW APARTMENT — NIGHT

> *Geoffrey and Olivia are on the sofa watching TV, her feet in his lap. A knock. Geoffrey opens the door. It's Donald, alone and nervous.*

GEOFFREY *(surprised)* Donald. What are you doing here?

DONALD I need to talk to you and Michael. Properly. Can we meet at the office tomorrow?

GEOFFREY *(after a beat)* Yes. No problem. I'll come.

> *INT. MICHAEL'S HOUSE — SAME NIGHT. Michael opens his door to Donald. Sophia waves from the kitchen.*

MICHAEL Donald?

DONALD Tomorrow. The office. Please.

MICHAEL *(studying him)* Okay. Sure, I'll come.

GUESS THE TWIST · TICK ONE

Donald is knocking on doors at night. Why?

- ☐ To fight them again
- ☐ To apologise and return their shares
- ☐ To buy Durose Holdings

Revealed in **Scene 37 →**

↑ All scenes

SCENE 37 OF 38 · 29:15–30:35 VOW TESTED

Cheers to a New Chapter

INT. THREE BOYS VENTURES — BOARDROOM — NEXT DAY

> *Three chairs and three glasses. Donald slides two folders across the table.*

DONALD Your shares. I'm not buying them. I'm giving them back. *(beat)* And I owe you an apology, Geoffrey. What I said to Olivia, I'll be ashamed of forever.

GEOFFREY *(quietly)* You were scared.

DONALD I was controlling. That's what I do when I'm scared. It took losing my brothers to hear it.

MICHAEL So let's tell it all. Properly. No more secrets.

DONALD I'll go first. I broke it for a girl with a red pen. Best thing I ever broke.

MICHAEL I broke it for a writer who sat in my chair and told me I was in her story. *(beat)* She was right.

GEOFFREY I broke it for a woman who called my father a thief. *(beat)* She was right too.

> *They laugh, really laugh, for the first time in months.*

DONALD We made that vow as hungry boys in grown men's suits. So afraid of losing anything, we promised never to have anything worth losing.

GEOFFREY There's more to life than chasing goals. We can still be bosses. *(beat)* And husbands. Fathers. A legacy that isn't just a building.

MICHAEL *(raising his glass)* Then cheers. To a new chapter.

DONALD & GEOFFREY To a new chapter.

> *Three glasses clink.*

TWIST REVEALED · Donald is knocking on doors at night. Why? The answer: **To apologise and return their shares**. See what you guessed in Scene 36 →

↑ All scenes

SCENE 38 OF 38 · 30:35 — END VOW TESTED

The New Vow

EXT. THE OLD AJEGUNLE ROOFTOP — SUNSET — SIX MONTHS LATER

Quick flashes first. Geoffrey and Olivia's wedding, with Mr. Lawal walking Olivia down the aisle and Mrs. Durose crying in the front row. Michael kneeling to Sophia on Badagry beach as she screams "YES!". Donald and Emma carrying boxes into their new home, laughing.

Then the rooftop. Fairy lights and three leather chairs. Emma, Sophia and Olivia sit on the steps sharing suya and laughing. Donald, Michael and Geoffrey stand at the edge where three hungry boys once sat. Geoffrey holds a bottle. He pours some of the drink onto the old zinc, a libation.

GEOFFREY *(looking down at the zinc)* To young Donald, young Michael and young Geoffrey. We're sorry. We couldn't keep the vow you made.

MICHAEL We made it when we were foolish. We thought love would make us weak.

DONALD Now we know better. We want to make you proud. A home full of love and truth will do that.

GEOFFREY *(turning to them)* So let's make a new vow. Here. Where it all began. *(He raises his glass.)* From today, we vow to always be happy. And to only do the things that make us, and the people we love, truly happy.

MICHAEL I subscribe to that.

DONALD *(smiling)* Yes. Let's go with that.

ALL THREE Sworn.

Three glasses clink. Behind them, the three women cheer. Olivia catches Geoffrey's eye and smiles.

The camera rises slowly from the rooftop, over the zinc roofs of Ajegunle, over the lagoon and up into the golden Lagos sky.

THE SWORN BACHELORS. THE END.

END

↑ All scenes

Answer key

Scene 4 → revealed in Scene 32

Olivia believes Jacob Durose killed her father. Did he? **No, but he stole the company.** Elias's heart failed at his desk. That same night Jacob forged the papers and took the company. He confessed it all on a hidden tape.

Scene 5 → revealed in Scene 13

“Jacob & Elias. Partners forever.” Were they really partners? **No, Jacob was Elias's employee.** Baba Sule said Jacob was Elias's clerk for fifteen years. He was promised shares every year and never got one.

Scene 9 → revealed in Scene 34

“Who wants to fall in love with a woman like that?” Will Geoffrey break the vow? **Yes, for Olivia.** In the boardroom he said: “I broke the vow. I'm in love with Olivia Hart.”

Scene 19 → revealed in Scene 21

Geoffrey is locked in a cell. Who gets him out? **Olivia's Uncle Rotimi.** Olivia's uncle called the Controller, while Donald and Michael were busy fighting each other.

Scene 23 → revealed in Scene 24

Olivia ordered him to stay in his hospital bed. Will he? **No, he pulls out his drip and follows her.** He pulled out the drip, climbed out of the window and arrived at the prison before Mr. Lawal did.

Scene 24 → revealed in Scene 32

Where are the real company documents? **In Jacob's lodge, with the guns.** Hidden in a steel box behind Jacob's gun cabinet at his forest lodge, with a tape addressed to Geoffrey.

Scene 28 → revealed in Scene 31

Olivia walked out over the vow. What brings them back together? **Danger at the lodge.** A wild dog attacked her at the lodge, and Geoffrey saved her with his father's rifle.

Scene 33 → revealed in Scene 34

Geoffrey chose Olivia. What happens to the brothers' empire? **Geoffrey and Michael walk away and leave it all to Donald.** Both resigned in one meeting, and Donald was left alone with the whole empire.

Scene 36 → revealed in Scene 37

Donald is knocking on doors at night. Why? **To apologise and return their shares.** He gave the shares back, apologised to Geoffrey and Olivia, and the three brothers toasted a new chapter.

Your detective score

Count your correct guesses. **0–3:** Jacob fooled you too. **4–6:** sharp, like Olivia. **7–9:** you saw the truth before Geoffrey did.

The Sworn Bachelors trilogy ends here: three brothers, three broken vows, one new vow.